

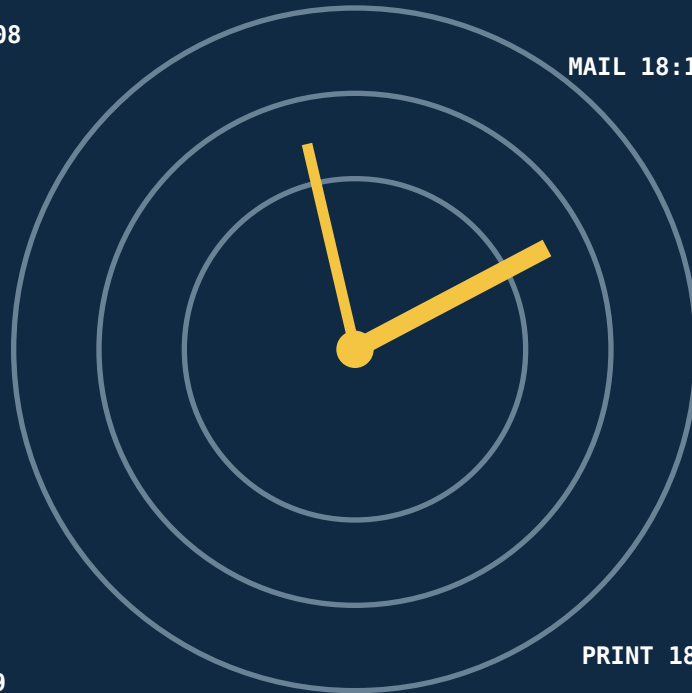
CASE ZERO

THE ELEVEN-MINUTE GAP

Five clocks disagree. One document is lying.

ACCESS 18:08

MAIL 18:11



LIFT 18:09

PRINT 18:03

A 25-35 MINUTE PREQUEL LOGIC CASE

SCREEN-FIRST • FILLABLE CASE BOARD • ONE VERIFIED SOLUTION

No register. No name filtering. No knowledge of the main case required.

Read this first

This case is designed for a phone, tablet or computer. You do not need to print it.

YOUR TASK

Reconstruct one eleven-minute window, identify who entered Archive 4, and prove why the document found inside could not be genuine.

HOW TO PLAY

- 1 Read the incident and meet the four people.
- 2 Use simultaneous events to correct the five system clocks.
- 3 Convert the archive-door times into actual time.
- 4 Complete the fillable Case Board before opening the solution.

IMPORTANT

The timestamps are accurate records of what each system displayed. The systems simply did not agree. Do not assume that 18:08 on one log means 18:08 actual time.

The incident

Halloway called it a document variance. Daniel Wren called it an entry.

At 18:14 on Thursday, 14 November 2024, Records Supervisor Harriet Cole found the blue seal on Archive 4 broken. The corridor camera had gone offline at 18:00 and returned at 18:11. Inside, the Northbridge exception memorandum occupied the correct folder and the correct position.

That was the first thing wrong with it.

The memorandum was dated 14 February 2017. It appeared to authorise a reserve adjustment now being processed by Finance. If genuine, the adjustment was routine. If inserted that evening, somebody had manufactured authority seven years after the event.

Archive 4 has one ordinary badge door and one service door. During the camera outage the ordinary door recorded no badge entry. The service door recorded a manual override. Its emergency key was normally kept in a sealed cabinet inside the Secure Print Room.

Four employees remained relevant. Each gave an account supported by a Halloway timestamp. Unfortunately, Halloway had several timestamps and only one actual time.

THE QUESTIONS

When did the service door open? Who used it? What was replaced?

Four people

Their statements are claims, not conclusions. Test each one against corrected time.

HARRIET COLE

RECORDS SUPERVISOR

Said she was trapped in Lift 2 until its controller displayed 18:09. She had sealed Archive 4 at 17:50, before entering the lift.

SIMON BELL

IT SUPPORT ENGINEER

Said he spent the entire camera outage on a fixed telephone in the Server Room with an external vendor. His request to inspect Archive 4's camera wiring had been refused the previous week.

MARCUS REED

COMPLIANCE OFFICER

Said he left before 18:00. The car-park barrier displayed 17:54 when his vehicle passed through.

PRIYA NAIR

RESERVE ACCOUNTING ANALYST

Said she released a private two-page print job when the printer displayed 18:03, then returned directly to Finance.

How the clocks work

Every offset is a whole number of minutes. Seconds are preserved.

OFFSET NOTATION

$$\text{DISPLAYED TIME} = \text{ACTUAL TIME} + \text{OFFSET}$$

Example: an offset of +6 means the system displays six minutes fast.

RULES ESTABLISHED BY THE CLOCK AUDIT

- The central switchboard clock is the master reference and shows actual time.
- Each of the five local systems has a fixed offset throughout the incident.
- When the same event appears on two systems, the seconds match exactly.
- Audit check only: after deriving them, the five offsets should be different and fall from -6 to +6 minutes, inclusive. Do not use this rule to guess them.
- A timestamp is not false merely because its clock is wrong.

DANIEL'S NOTE

Start with the events that happened once but were recorded twice.

Evidence A

The lift fault appears on three systems.

EXHIBIT A

RETAINED COPY

Facilities incident bundle - Lift 2

SYSTEM	DISPLAYED	EVENT
Switchboard	17:56:12	Emergency call received from Lift 2
Lift controller	17:54:12	CAR STOP / intercom opened
Lift controller	18:09:40	SERVICE RESTORED / doors released
Mail server	18:17:40	Automated message: Lift 2 restored

FACILITIES CERTIFICATION

The emergency call and the controller's CAR STOP event were triggered by the same button press. The SERVICE RESTORED event and the automated email were generated by the same reset command.

WHAT THIS CAN ESTABLISH

First correct the lift controller. Then use its reset event to correct the mail server.

Evidence B

The archive service door sent its own alert.

EXHIBIT B

RETAINED COPY

Archive 4 - service-door events

SYSTEM	DISPLAYED	EVENT
Access controller	18:08:15	MANUAL OVERRIDE / service door open
Mail server	18:11:15	Automated security alert: Archive 4
Access controller	18:12:00	CONTACT CLOSED / service door secure

CONTROLLER SPECIFICATION

The door controller writes its local timestamp first. The mail alert is generated by the same electrical contact, not by a later human report.

CAMERA MAINTENANCE - MASTER TIME

OFFLINE 18:00:00 → ONLINE 18:11:00

The maintenance window was posted internally that morning. The master-clock camera covers the full route between Archive 4 and the Secure Print Room. At 18:11:00 its feed returned on an empty corridor.

Evidence C

Two accounts can be tested against master time.

EXHIBIT C

RETAINED COPY

Switchboard and car-park extracts

SOURCE	DISPLAYED	RECORD
Switchboard	17:58:33	Call from M. Reed's mobile: 'Barrier open now.'
Barrier controller	17:54:33	Vehicle MR-17 exited; arm opened
Switchboard	18:00:04	Server Room ext. 4451 called vendor support
Switchboard	18:11:28	Same fixed-line call ended

VERIFICATION

Reception heard Marcus Reed while his car was beneath the exit barrier. The vehicle gate and pedestrian turnstile recorded no return by him; the perimeter had no other entrance. The support call remained connected to Simon Bell at the fixed Server Room handset for its full duration.

QUESTION

Where were Marcus and Simon when the archive door actually opened?

Evidence D

One badge touch created two different timestamps.

EXHIBIT D

RETAINED COPY

Secure Print Room - access and output

SYSTEM	DISPLAYED	EVENT
Access controller	18:05:20	P. NAIR entered Secure Print Room
Print server	18:03:20	PNAIR / PRIVATE.PDF / 2 pages / Tray 3

SECURE-RELEASE RULE

Private jobs print only when an employee badge touches the room reader; these two entries are the same physical event. Tray 3 held K-24 stock. Every sheet it printed on 14 November carried the day mark T3-1114, which appears on the recovered copy. The mark identifies tray and date, not a specific job.

SERVICE-KEY CABINET

Archive 4's emergency key was sealed in the cabinet beside the printer at 17:45 master time. P. Nair was the only badge entry before the archive seal was found broken at 18:14. At 18:17, Security found the cabinet seal broken and the key missing.

WALKING TIME

Secure Print Room → Archive 4: between 1 minute 20 seconds and 1 minute 45 seconds.

Evidence E

The recovered document carries two dates it does not display.

EXHIBIT E

RETAINED COPY

Northbridge exception memorandum - comparison

FEATURE	ARCHIVE INDEX	RECOVERED COPY
Stated date	14 February 2017	14 February 2017
Originating unit	Risk Settlement Review	Settlement Integrity Unit
Length	2 leaves	2 leaves
Paper	F-series office stock	K-24 watermark

CORPORATE RECORDS

The Settlement Integrity Unit was created on 1 July 2019. K-24 paper stock was first issued on 4 November 2024. No 2017 memorandum could carry either feature.

CURRENT FINANCE QUERY

Northbridge reserve adjustment - P. Nair / M. Reed

Finance preparation / compliance review - authority: memorandum dated 14 February 2017

Case Board

If the pale fields do not save, use any Notes app. Printing is unnecessary.

1 - CORRECT THE CLOCKS

Lift controller

Mail server

Access controller

Barrier controller

Print server

2 - RECONSTRUCT THE DOOR EVENT

Actual opening time

Actual closing time

3 - CLOSE THE CASE

Who used the service door?

What proves the memorandum was created after 2017?

Why does the two-page print job matter?

Hint - Level 1

A method hint only. No offset is revealed on this page.

LEVEL 1 - METHOD

Find simultaneous pairs. The switchboard and Lift 2 record the same emergency button press. The lift and mail systems record the same reset. The access and mail systems record the same archive-door contact. The access and print systems record the same badge touch.

WORK IN THIS ORDER

- A** Use master switchboard time to correct the lift.
- B** Use the lift reset to correct the mail server.
- C** Use the mail alert to correct the access controller.
- D** Use corrected access time to correct the print server.

Keep the barrier separate: it compares directly with the master switchboard.

Hint - Level 2A

Open this only if the first two links in the clock chain are blocking you.

LIFT -2 minutes

MAIL +6 minutes

The emergency call fixes the lift; the shared reset fixes mail.

CALCULATION

Lift fault: 17:54:12 displayed = 17:56:12 actual. Lift reset: 18:09:40 displayed = 18:11:40 actual. The mail records that same reset as 18:17:40, so mail is six minutes fast.

Try Evidence B again before opening Level 2B.

Hint - Level 2B

This reveals the access-controller offset, but not the door times.

ACCESS +3 minutes

Mail 18:11:15 and access 18:08:15 are the same door contact.

YOUR NEXT STEP

Subtract three minutes from both access-controller records. Write the actual opening and closing times on the Case Board before revealing any other offset.

If you can now test the four accounts, stop here.

Hint - Level 2C

The two remaining offsets are independent checks, not a shortcut to the culprit.

BARRIER -4 minutes

PRINT +1 minute

The barrier compares with master time; print compares with corrected access.

AUTOCHECK

Your completed set should be: lift -2, mail +6, access +3, barrier -4 and print +1. All are different and all fall from -6 to +6 minutes, inclusive.

Return to the Case Board. Use the final hint only if the people still do not resolve.

Final hint

This reveals the critical time window, but not the complete proof.

DOOR OPENED 18:05:15

DOOR CLOSED 18:09:00

Both times fall inside the camera gap.

ASK THREE QUESTIONS

- 1 Who was outside the building and could not return?**
- 2 Who was physically committed throughout the door-open interval?**
- 3 Who had both the emergency key and a newly printed two-page document?**

Do not stop at opportunity. Your answer should also explain the K-24 stock and the unit name on a document dated 2017.

Solution gate

Stop here until you can answer all three sections of the Case Board.

**READY TO
CLOSE THE CASE?**

The next page contains the full answer.

OPEN THE VERIFIED SOLUTION

You can return to the Case Board using the navigation below.

Verified solution

Priya Nair used the Archive 4 service door and replaced the Northbridge memorandum.

RAW RECORD	OFFSET	ACTUAL TIME
Access: door open 18:08:15	+3	18:05:15
Access: door closed 18:12:00	+3	18:09:00
Print: release 18:03:20	+1	18:02:20

WHY THE TIMELINE IDENTIFIES HER

Marcus was outside by 17:58:33, with no recorded return. Simon remained on the fixed Server Room call from 18:00:04 to 18:11:28. Harriet remained trapped until 18:11:40. Priya entered Secure Print at 18:02:20, could take the missing key and reach Archive 4 by 18:05:15. After closing at 18:09:00, the slower return route cleared the corridor by 18:10:45, before the camera resumed.

WHY THE DOCUMENT IDENTIFIES THE ACT

The recovered copy's K-24 stock and T3-1114 day mark prove it came from Tray 3 on 14 November, but do not identify a job. Priya's two-page private job matches the pages; the corrected timeline is what places her at Archive 4. The memorandum also named a unit that did not exist until 2019. It was newly made to look old.

PURPOSE

The adjustment carried both Priya's and Marcus's names. The timeline excludes Marcus and leaves Priya with the access, document and opportunity to manufacture retroactive authority.

DANIEL WREN - NOTEBOOK

The clocks were not lying. They were consistent. We were wrong about what their numbers meant.

CASE STATUS: CLOSED • NEXT FILE: PENDING